



Across Africa, access to safe water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) remains a fundamental development challenge, with major implications for health, dignity, education, livelihoods and resilience. [UNICEF and WHO report](#) that in 2022 only 31% of Africa's population had access to safely managed sanitation, while only 28% had access to basic hygiene services; achieving universal WASH coverage by 2030 would require progress on safely managed sanitation to accelerate 23-fold. Uganda reflects this wider challenge.

[According to UNICEF's 2022 country estimates](#), only 18% of the population uses safely managed drinking water, while 45% use basic services, meaning 37% remain below even basic drinking-water access¹; for sanitation, only 20% use safely managed services and just 24% have at least basic sanitation. The challenge is not simply whether a water point or latrine exists, but whether communities can access services that are safe, reliable, affordable and sustainable. [Uganda's 2022 Demographic and Health Survey](#) further found that only 52% of households had an improved drinking-water source, while only 31% had improved sanitation facilities, underscoring the gap between infrastructure provision and genuinely safe, functional and sustainable services.

For OEF, this gap presents a clear opportunity to advance access to safe water, sanitation and hygiene as a practical pathway to building healthier, more resilient and dignified communities in Uganda. OEF will focus on vulnerable communities where limited access, climate risks and inadequate infrastructure intersect, supporting locally led, affordable and climate-resilient WASH solutions while strengthening community capacity to sustain them. Through partnerships with communities, government, technical actors and funders, OEF will demonstrate practical, measurable and replicable solutions that contribute directly to its commitment to Access, Resilience and Impact.

¹ See <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SH.H2O.SMDW.ZS?locations=UG>